

**UNITED STATES DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE
OFFICE OF THE SECRETARY
WASHINGTON, D.C. 20250**

SECRETARY'S MEMORANDUM 1077-011

March 13, 2024

**Delegation of Authority for the Under Secretary for
Farm Production and Conservation
Under Section 607 of the Rural Development Act of 1972**

1. PURPOSE

The purpose of this memorandum is to delegate authority to the Under Secretary for the Farm Production and Conservation (FPAC) Mission Area to enter into cooperative agreements with Federal agencies, State and local governments, and any other organization or individual related to the financial and technical assistance required to render support to FPAC agencies and programs.

2. DELEGATIONS

- a. The Under Secretary for FPAC is hereby delegated the authority vested in the Secretary under Section 607(b)(4) of the Rural Development Act of 1972 (7 United States Code (U.S.C.) 2204b(b)(4)) to enter into cooperative agreements with Federal agencies, State and local governments, and any other organization or individual related to financial and technical assistance.
- b. This delegation allows the Under Secretary for FPAC to enter into cooperative agreements to improve the efficiency and effectiveness of Federal programs that affect rural areas under the FPAC Mission Area.

3. EXISTING DIRECTIVES

Prior delegations of authority, administrative regulations, and other directives not inconsistent with the provisions of this Memorandum will remain in full force and effect.

4. EFFECTIVE DATE AND TERMINATION

This delegation is effective immediately and will remain in effect for 1 year from the effective date, or until such earlier time as the Department's published

delegations of authority have been revised to incorporate the provisions of this Memorandum.

/s/ Thomas J. Vilsack
Secretary of Agriculture